

Breathwork for Men Over 40: Mental Recovery Techniques to Reduce Stress, Improve Focus, and Optimize Health

With Funk Roberts

Episode Overview Summary

Most men focus on workouts.

Many focus on nutrition.

Some focus on supplements.

Very few focus on breathing.

In this powerful presentation, Funk Roberts breaks down why breathwork may be one of the most underutilized tools for improving physical health, mental health, recovery, stress management, focus, hormonal balance, and overall performance after 40.

Drawing from his experiences as a professional athlete, martial artist, fitness coach, and survivor of a life-threatening lung condition, Funk explains how diaphragmatic breathing, deep breathing, tactical breathing, and power breathing can dramatically improve how men recover physically and mentally.

The presentation explores the science behind the sympathetic and parasympathetic nervous systems, the connection between chronic stress and declining testosterone, and how simple breathing techniques can help men improve focus, reduce anxiety, lower stress, and make better decisions under pressure.

Most importantly, Funk reframes breathwork not as something "woo-woo," but as a practical performance and recovery tool that every man should have in his toolbox.

What You Will Learn

- ✓ Why breathwork becomes more important after age 40
- ✓ The connection between stress and declining testosterone
- ✓ How breathing affects recovery and performance
- ✓ The difference between sympathetic and parasympathetic nervous systems
- ✓ Why most men live in a chronic fight-or-flight state
- ✓ How diaphragmatic breathing improves oxygen intake
- ✓ Why belly breathing is superior to chest breathing
- ✓ How tactical breathing is used by military operators
- ✓ The role breathwork plays in managing anxiety and stress
- ✓ How breathing impacts cognitive function and decision-making
- ✓ The connection between breathwork and emotional resilience
- ✓ Why breathwork can improve sleep quality
- ✓ How breathing affects heart rate variability
- ✓ The relationship between cortisol and testosterone
- ✓ How breathwork supports cardiovascular health
- ✓ Why breathwork helped accelerate Funk's recovery from a serious lung condition
- ✓ The benefits of Wim Hof power breathing
- ✓ How to build a daily breathwork routine

- ✓ **Why mental recovery is just as important as physical recovery**
 - ✓ **The exact breathing methods men can begin using immediately**
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Chapter / Timeline Breakdown

Chapter 1: Why Breathwork Matters for Men Over 40

0:00 – 4:00

Key Takeaways

Funk introduces breathwork as one of the most powerful recovery tools available for men.

He explains how recovery extends beyond workouts and includes:

- Mental recovery
- Emotional recovery
- Physiological recovery
- Hormonal recovery

The foundation of long-term health starts with how well you recover.

Chapter 2: Lessons Learned as an Athlete

4:00 – 10:00

Key Takeaways

Funk shares early experiences from:

- Professional volleyball
- Muay Thai training
- Royce Gracie seminars
- O2 Trainer breathing systems

These experiences introduced him to the power of oxygen utilization and diaphragmatic breathing.

Chapter 3: The Lung Disease That Changed Everything

10:00 – 15:00

Key Takeaways

One of the most powerful stories in the presentation.

Funk explains how he developed Cryptogenic Organizing Pneumonia and was placed on Prednisone with a projected recovery timeline of up to two years.

Through breathing exercises, training, and recovery strategies, he dramatically accelerated his healing process.

This experience solidified his belief in the power of breathwork.

Chapter 4: The Mental Health Crisis Facing Men

15:00 – 20:00

Key Takeaways

Funk discusses:

- Stress
- Anxiety
- Depression
- Emotional suppression
- Suicide rates among men

He explains why many men wear a "mask" and never address their emotional health.

Breathwork becomes a tool for emotional recovery and resilience.

Chapter 5: Understanding Your Nervous System

20:00 – 30:00

Key Takeaways

Funk breaks down:

Sympathetic Nervous System

Fight-or-flight

- Increased heart rate
- Elevated blood pressure
- Stress response
- Survival mode

Parasympathetic Nervous System

Rest-and-digest

- Recovery
- Healing
- Relaxation
- Hormonal optimization

The goal is not eliminating stress but learning to regulate it.

Chapter 6: Why Breathwork Improves Health

30:00 – 38:00

Key Takeaways

Research-backed benefits include:

- Lower stress
- Better cardiovascular health
- Improved cognition
- Reduced anxiety
- Better hormonal balance
- Improved recovery

Breathwork becomes a tool for overall health optimization.

Chapter 7: Diaphragmatic Breathing Explained

38:00 – 43:00

Key Takeaways

Funk explains:

- Belly breathing
- Oxygen exchange
- Lung expansion
- Improved relaxation

This becomes the foundation of all future breathing techniques.

Chapter 8: Deep Breathing for Recovery and Focus

43:00 – 47:00

Key Takeaways

Deep breathing:

- Enhances oxygen delivery
- Improves recovery
- Supports cardiovascular function
- Increases relaxation

This technique becomes essential for daily recovery.

Chapter 9: Tactical Breathing and Military Performance

47:00 – 50:00

Key Takeaways

Funk introduces:

Box Breathing (4-4-4-4)

- Inhale 4 seconds
- Hold 4 seconds
- Exhale 4 seconds
- Hold 4 seconds

Used by:

- Navy SEALs
- Military operators
- Elite performers

Purpose:

Improve focus under pressure.

Chapter 10: Wim Hof Power Breathing

50:00 – 56:00

Key Takeaways

Funk shares his personal experience with:

- 30 power breaths
- Breath holds
- Recovery breathing

Benefits include:

- Increased energy
- Emotional release
- Mental clarity
- Improved resilience

One of the most transformative experiences of his recovery journey.

Chapter 11: Creating Your Daily Breathwork Practice

56:00 – End

Key Takeaways

Funk outlines how to build a daily routine:

1. Gratitude journaling
2. Meditation
3. Breathwork

He emphasizes consistency over complexity.

Just a few minutes daily can create meaningful long-term change.

Full Bio

Funk Roberts



Funk Roberts is one of the world's leading fitness experts for men over 40 and the creator of the **Over 40 Alpha Brotherhood**, one of the largest online men's health and fitness communities dedicated to helping men reclaim their health, fitness, hormones, confidence, and vitality.

A former professional beach volleyball player and professional Muay Thai fighter, Funk has spent more than 25 years helping men transform their bodies and lives through science-backed fitness, testosterone optimization, nutrition, recovery, mindset training, and sustainable lifestyle strategies.

As a Certified Hormone and Testosterone Specialist, Certified Master Metabolic Trainer, bestselling author, and creator of the Over 40 Alpha Brotherhood, Funk has helped thousands of men naturally increase testosterone, lose belly fat, build lean muscle, improve mental health, and regain control of their lives.

His expertise has been featured on major media outlets including ABC, NBC, CBS, FOX, GQ, Men's Journal, and Muscle & Fitness. Through his coaching, courses, podcasts, and programs, Funk continues his mission of helping men over 40 become stronger, leaner, healthier, and more powerful than ever before.

In this presentation, Funk shares one of the most overlooked recovery tools available to men today: **breathwork**